

Figure 42: The model subdivided once

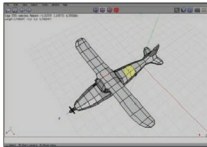


Figure 43: A look at the model from the top

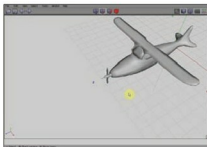


Figure 44: Tab key pressed to display smooth subdivision

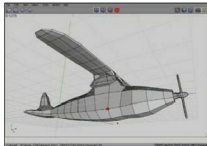


Figure 45: Vertices mode, select and bevel vertex for wing supporter

holder, as shown in Figure 38.

Select the top and bottom polygons, inset and extrude it twice, giving it the shape of a propeller, as shown in Figures 39 to 41.

Now, it is time to create a subdivision level, for a better look. Make a *Doo Sabin Subdivision* from the RMB menu.

Now to create the support bars for the wings. Select two vertices on the

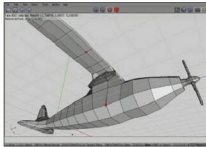


Figure 46: Select upper wing vertex, bevel for supporter

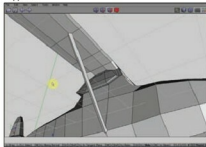


Figure 47: Bridge bevelled faces to form supporters

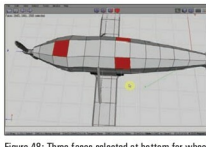


Figure 48: Three faces selected at bottom for wheels

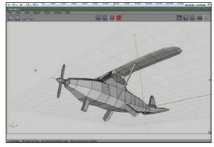


Figure 49: Supporters extruded from the three faces

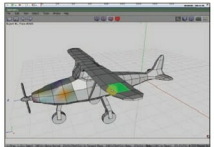


Figure 50: Three cylinders flattened to position as wheels

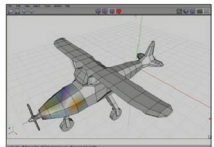


Figure 51: The final airplane

Key	Function
Ctrl+n	New file
Ctrl+o	Open file
Ctrl+l	Merge file
Ctrl+s	Save file
Shift+Ctrl+s	Save file as
Ctrl+q	Quit

Table 4: File keys

opposite sides, and bevel them a little. Similarly, take two vertices below the wings, on the opposite sides, and bevel them. Select the bevelled vertex on the

wing and on the lower body, and *bridge* it with the Bridge command. Repeat it for the other side (see Figures 45 to 47).

Now for the wheels: Select three polygons below the plane body—one for the front wheel, and two for the side wheels. Extrude the polygons to form the supporters. Add a cylinder and shape it to form the tyre. TriPLICATE it to form all the three wheels. Position them by moving them (see Figures 48 to 50).

That's all for the free-form modelling, folks. I will continue the UV mapping in the next issue. 

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The author is a lecturer by profession. He is also a great 3D enthusiast, creating quality digital content and sharing his knowledge of 3D with those interested. He is conversant with most of the open source 3D programs like Blender, Wings 3D, k3D, Art of Illusion, Anim8tor, etc. At present, he works as a lecturer in the department of English at Sri Sathya Sai Institute of Higher Learning, Bangalore.